

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's *Reflections on:* **PRAYER,** **PROCLAMATION and** **PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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OH, THAT I HAD THE WINGS OF A DOVE

Psalms 55:6-8

Have we ever felt that we had “wings” enabling us to fly away from the pressures of life and ministry and find some peace and rest?



I thought it's timely to present to you TWO THINGS that affects our lives and service.

THE FIRST is in relation to those times when we feel overwhelmed by life and pressures that causes us to wish we had wings to “fly away”, to get way from and desperately desiring to find rest, peace and freedom in the midst of such turmoil.

THE SECOND is related with the sorrow and hurt from the betrayal of a close friend, a fellow worker, someone with whom we have walked and fellowshiped together and then suddenly they depart from you or turns against you.

Flying away

Psalms 55:3-8.12-14. 20,21

3 My enemies shout against me and threaten me with death. They surround me with terror and plot to kill me. Their fury and hatred rise to engulf me. 4 My heart is in anguish within me. Stark fear overpowers me.

5 Trembling and horror overwhelm me. 6 Oh, for wings like a dove, to fly away and rest! 7 I would fly to the far-off deserts and stay there. 8 I would flee to some refuge from all this storm.

12 It was not an enemy who taunted me-then I could have borne it; I could have hidden and escaped. 13 But it was you, a man like myself, my companion and my friend. 14 What fellowship we had, what wonderful discussions as we walked together to the Temple of the Lord on holy days.

20 This friend of mine betrayed me-I who was at peace with him. He broke his promises. 21 His words were oily smooth, but in his heart was war. His words were sweet, but underneath were daggers. TLB

Psalms 55:6 expresses David's intense desire to escape his troubles and find peace. David's cry “Oh, that I had the wings of a dove! I would fly away and be at rest” has meaning with anyone who has ever felt overwhelmed by life and wished to “get away” from their problems.

In this Psalm David describes his trouble and the intense, negative feelings that overwhelm him. He is deeply hurt because of the betrayal by a close friend and partner. But David is confident that God will rescue him from his enemies.

In times of deep distress, we also long for freedom—from pain, betrayal, and overwhelming pressures. This sentiment echoes through the verses as David expresses his inner feelings of his desire to escape his troubles. He LONGS for wings like a dove, so he can flee to safety and solitude, away from the conspiracies and treachery that surround him.

Applies also to us

This also speaks to us who at times feel so pressured and overwhelmed with similar things that we long for a quiet place where we can rest and be shielded from such things.

Closest friend

David's heart is heavy with sorrow, primarily because the betrayal of a close friend which adds to the agony of his suffering.

Such betrayal is a universal experience that can shake one's faith in relationships and emphasizes the emotional hurt of human conflict.

So, David's longing for escape expressed in his agony illustrates the depth of his anguish and this illustrates the struggles that believers face in finding peace in the midst of such turmoil.

Oh, that I had wings like a dove! for then I would fly away, and be at rest. (Psalms 55:6)

He reaches out to God, his ultimate refuge and being fully aware that true rest can only be found in divine deliverance.

My own familiar / close friend

At this stage we are reminded of the scriptures that refer to the betrayal of Jesus by his own familiar friend, Judas.

Of one that walked with him, had fellowship and saw the miracles and heard his teachings but yet betrayed him for money.

Psalms 41:9 Yea, mine own familiar friend, in whom I trusted, which did eat of my bread, hath lifted up his heel against me. KJV

Psalms 41:9 Even my close friend, whom I trusted, he who shared my bread, has lifted up his heel against me. NIV

Psalms 41:9 Even my own familiar friend, in whom I trusted (relied on and was confident), who ate of my bread, has lifted up his heel against me. [John 13:18.] AMP

John 13:18 I am not speaking of and I do not mean all of you. I know whom I have chosen; but it is that the Scripture may be fulfilled, He who eats My bread with Me has raised up his heel against Me. [Psalms 41:9.] AMP

In Ministry Life

The disappointment and hurt felt **when those close to us fail us** in some way.

It could be a team member that has worked together with you over a long period that suddenly leaves you and shows disloyalty even criticism of you.

Someone that you have shared fellowship and walked together with you in the good and bad times, and then leaves without explaining why. Then we are left with the troubling questions why? Was it something that I have done or failed to do?

This is always a difficult time when presented with this kind of event, but it does happen in life particularly in the life of **ministry**.

Not my enemy

It was not my enemy that reproaches and scoffs me for because that I could bear, **but it was my friend and companion**. His words of his mouth were smoother than cream or butter, but war was in his heart; his words were softer than oil, yet they were drawn swords.

Psalms 55:12-14. 20,21

12 For it is not an enemy who reproaches and taunts me — then I might bear it; nor is it one who has hated me who insolently vaunts himself against me — then I might hide from him.

13 But it was you, a man my equal, my companion and my familiar friend. 14 We had sweet fellowship together and used to walk to the house of God in company.

20 [My companion] has put forth his hands against those who were at peace with him; he has broken and profaned his agreement [of friendship and loyalty]. 21 The words of his mouth were smoother than cream or butter, but war was in his heart; his words were softer than oil, yet they were drawn swords. AMP

Here are some things that we can do to help ourselves to rise above such disappointing events.

These may not have prevented your familiar friend from leaving you but they can help you be more aware of where your fellow workers are journeying.

Firstly, ask God's forgiveness for anything that you might have done or failed to do which might have caused this kind of event to happen even if you are unaware of any specific cause.

Secondly, what can you learn from this event so as possibly prevent future events from happening.

Questions to ask ourselves.

- Do I need to spend more time in one to one with each of your key workers?
- Should I be more transparent and open about myself with my workers, companions.
- You need to be little more intrusive with questions to those fellow key workers in the ministry so you can find out how they are doing spiritually and whether they are they struggling with anything.
- For you to make whatever changes, adjustments need to your scheduling for you to have regular time with your key workers.

Remembering the following scriptures

Paul had a similar experience see (verse 15) Men opposed his message, and no one supported or stood with him, all deserted him.

But he was not ashamed because he knew that Jesus would take care of those things (our failures etc) that he had entrusted to him.

2 Timothy 1:12-15

12 That is why I am suffering as I am. Yet I am not ashamed, because I know whom I have believed, and am convinced that he is able to guard what I have entrusted to him for that day.

13 What you heard from me, keep as the pattern of sound teaching, with faith and love in Christ Jesus. 14 Guard the good deposit that was entrusted to you — guard it with the help of the Holy Spirit who lives in us. 15 You know that everyone in the province of Asia has deserted me, including Phygelus and Hermogenes. NIV

2 Timothy 4:14-18

14 Alexander the metalworker did me a great deal of harm. The Lord will repay him for what he has done. 15 You too should be on your guard against him, because he strongly opposed our message. 16 At my first defense, no one came to my support, but everyone deserted me. May it not be held against them. 17 But the Lord stood at my side and gave me strength, so that through me the message might be fully proclaimed and all the Gentiles might hear it. And I was delivered from the lion's mouth. 18 The Lord will rescue me from every evil attack and will bring me safely to his heavenly kingdom. To him be glory for ever and ever. Amen. NIV

DAVID REACHED OUT TO GOD BECAUSE HE KNEW THAT HIS ULTIMATE REFUGE AND THAT TRUE REST CAN ONLY BE FOUND IN DIVINE DELIVERANCE.

SO LET US ALSO RISE UP ABOVE THESE DISAPPOINTMENTS AND DISCOURAGING EVENTS THAT WE ENCOUNTER AND TRUST IN GOD'S STRENGTH TO SEE HIS INTERVENTION AND DELIVERANCE.

Amen – Ps Barry